



twitter buyout: the good, bad & the ugly

How Did The World React To Elon Musk's Twitter Buyout?

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It's not been long since Elon Musk outright bought Twitter for a monumental sum of \$44 billion and, pardon my French but the proverbial s**t has hit the fan! I'm not even kidding, Twitter has exploded like a hornet's nest, with tweets flying left, right and centre. Everyone and their grandmum has been reacting to the world's richest man's purchase of the popular micro-blogging platform and how!

REACTIONS GALORE

The age of social media has given us unfettered access to movie stars, politicians, musicians, and everything in between. Some might say that it's a good thing, but the phrase 'never meet

your heroes' comes to mind here. But it seems like one man is here to change the way things are done on everyone's favourite bite-sized social media app, for better or worse.

Some are hailing Elon Musk's purchase of Twitter as the greatest victory for free speech in the modern era, while some decry it as a billionaire feeding his own over-inflated ego. While both may be right, the acquisition of Twitter has drawn some of the 'hottest' takes on freedom of speech and in the process highlighted a few glaring concerns that could derail the entire thing.

Over the years, Twitter has simultaneously become the world's largest platform for discourse and the world's largest septic tank. People's lives have been destroyed by 'discourse' on the platform, banned for wrong-think and even had their reach throttled by the almighty 'algorithm'.

What started as a well-meaning platform for debate and discussion, Twitter quickly turned into a political battleground that has even seen the banning of a former US President – while he was in power no less. It eventually got so bad that even co-founder Jack Dorsey of the platform resigned from his position as CEO, leaving Parag Agrawal to take over the hotseat. To say that American politics has seeped into every cultural moment in the past years is an understatement.

THE HOTTEST TAKES

Even though the platform was seen as toxic, it was still an important source for breaking news, updates and such. After all the controversy, it looks like the biggest one was just around the corner. The acquisition by Musk has been seen by some as an extravagant impulse purchase by a spoiled billionaire and that the 44 billion he spent could have been used to 'end world hunger'. Silly tweets, no doubt, but the seed of discord against Musk has already reared its head. As a bit of a rebuttal, if \$44 billion was all it took to end world hunger, how has it not happened already?

Others have even complained that the \$44 billion matches Joe Biden's climate change proposal.

US Senator Elizabeth Warren, who was recently derided for claiming Native American heritage when she



World hunger tweet